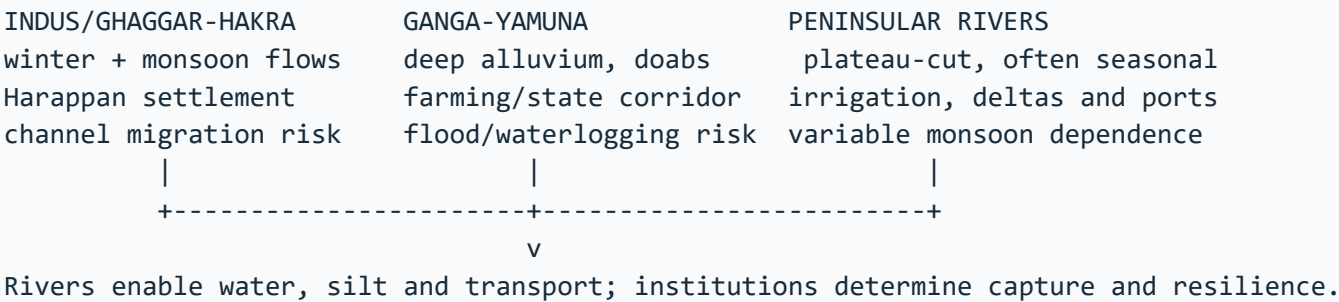


ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Subcontinent as connected ecological regions

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      HIMALAYA / NORTH-WEST PASSES
    Kabul-Indus corridors | snowmelt rivers | frontier exchange
          v
INDUS BASIN ---- THAR/ARAVALLI ---- GANGA PLAIN ---- BRAHMAPUTRA VALLEY
floodplains      copper/route      alluvium/rice      rain/river routes
          |
      VINDHYAS / CENTRAL BELT
          |
DECCAN PLATEAU ---- EASTERN/WESTERN GHATS ---- COASTS AND DELTAS
black soils/metals passes and rain shadow      ports, rice, maritime links
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: River systems as opportunity and hazard



ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Monsoon-ecology-production loop

SEASONAL MONSOON



Surplus and settlement depend on storage, water control, labour and risk-sharing.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Resource geography and specialised regions

RESOURCE -> REPRESENTATIVE ZONES -> HISTORICAL CAPACITY

copper -> Aravalli/Khetri -> tools, exchange, craft centres

iron -> central/eastern India -> tools and weapons; use remains contextual

stone -> Rohri/Deccan/Vindhya -> lithics, architecture and sculpture

timber -> forest belts -> fuel, construction, boats, state frontier

salt -> arid/coastal sources -> essential exchange networks

elephant -> eastern forests -> military resource, not sole cause of empire

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Why settlements occupy particular landscapes

SITE SELECTION

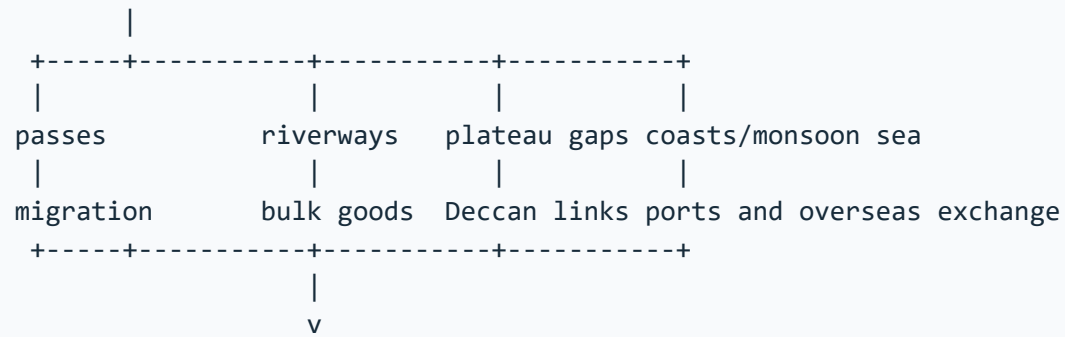
- |-- water reliability
- |-- cultivable soil and grazing
- |-- defensibility and flood safety
- |-- raw-material access
- |-- route, ford or port position
- |-- disease and drainage constraints
- |

+-> SETTLEMENT HIERARCHY: camp -> village -> craft centre -> town -> capital

Geography sets costs and options; social organisation converts them into settlement.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Routes: movement creates historical corridors

LAND AND WATER ROUTES



Goods, people, scripts, cults and technologies move; routes do not erase local agency.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Changing historical landscapes

PALAEOLITHIC	->	NEOLITHIC/CHALCOLITHIC	->	HARAPPAN	->	VEDIC	->	EARLY HISTORIC
mobile use		village mosaics		urban-rural		NW to Ganga		towns/states/routes
stone/water		crops/herds		basin links		forest edge		Magadha/Deccan/coasts
+-----+-----+-----+-----+								
v								

No all-India stage occurs simultaneously: regional sequences overlap and diverge.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Determinism versus possibilism

DETERMINIST CLAIM: fertile soil, iron, river or monsoon automatically produces a state.

EVIDENCE AGAINST: similar environments yield different timings and institutions.

POSSIBILIST CORRECTION: ecology offers constraints, opportunities and recurring risks.

MEDIATORS: technology + labour + property + exchange + political organisation + culture

|
v

VERDICT: explain why an opportunity was mobilised, by whom, and with what limits.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Historical-geography answer architecture

10 MARKS: locate region -> name resource/ecology -> mechanism -> named case

15 MARKS: text map -> opportunities + constraints -> institutional mediators -> variation

20 MARKS: physical frame -> river/monsoon/resource systems -> chronological cases

-> routes and uneven regions -> determinism debate -> qualified synthesis

MAP RULE: label only places used in the argument; link each label to one consequence.

CLOSE: geography conditions history, but institutions select and transform options.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Evidence ladder and confidence control

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. Convert relief, water, climate and resources into a dated historical mechanism.
2. Add technology, labour, institutions and power before claiming an outcome.
3. State each proxy's catchment, chronology, preservation and alternative causes.

VERDICT: Geography conditions choices; it does not dictate one inevitable history.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Examiner traps and contested boundaries

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Mountains are barriers and corridors; rivers are routes and changing hazards.
2. A palaeochannel is not a named textual river; correlation is not causation.
3. Resource maps are not political maps; modern borders are not ancient regions.

VERDICT: Date the landscape, match the scale and preserve regional variation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Integrated answer spine and qualified conclusion

ANSWER SPINE

1. For 2023 GS-I Q1, map mountain, plain, plateau, river, resource and coast.
2. Write factor -> mechanism -> named evidence -> outcome -> mediation -> limit.
3. Compare prehistoric, Harappan, Vedic and early historic uses of landscapes.

VERDICT: Societies selected, connected and transformed geographic possibilities.